

Depending on your Linux distribution, it might throw an error saying that the module wasn't found! This would be OK. So don't freak out. You need to load a separate KVM module depending on your processor. For Intel processor:

```
modprobe kvm-intel
```

For AMD processors:

```
modprobe kvm-amd
```

If the above commands spit out an error saying that the module isn't available, then you've got bad luck and you're unable to use KVM accelerations with Qemu. We assume that KVM module was loaded with the above commands. In case it failed and you still want to use Qemu, in all the commands that follow, you need to change the word "qemu-kvm" to just "qemu".

Now, since the module is loaded, it's time to create a virtual hard disk file. Qemu supports a few formats for virtual hard disk file that you can use to run the virtual machine later on. Interestingly enough, it supports the VMDK and VDI file types (though only of quite older versions of VMware Workstation and VirtualBox). We don't recommend creating a hard disk file in VDI or VMDK format unless creating the virtual disk and using it later in VirtualBox or VMware Workstation is the thing you're going to do. Qemu has its own virtual hard disk types as well and you can use them. You can use the `dd` command to create a RAW virtual hard disk file which can be used by Qemu or you can use the `qemu-img` command to create one in a desired format.

Using the `qemu-img` command:

```
qemu-img create -f qcow2 windows.hdd 8G
```

This will create a file named as "windows.hdd" with 8 GB capacity in the "qcow2" format. Remember that Qemu can be used to create snapshots of machines you use with it (details at: <http://wiki.qemu.org/Documentation/CreateSnapshot>) but it needs the qcow2 format for that to happen.

Using the `dd` command:

```
dd if=/dev/zero of=./windows.hdd bs=1M count=8192
```

Here we're asking the `dd` command to create a file named "windows.hdd" in the current directory with 8192 blocks of 1 MB (that's 8 GB) and fill it with zeros. We used this method when testing. Also, if the `qemu-img` command is unavailable, the `dd` command will get the job done.

The virtual hard disk file is created. We now need to install an operating system inside it. We'll try to install Windows XP. Issue the following command at the command line: